Applying for a mortgage: what do I need to arrange?

You want to buy a house. To pay for it, you want to take out a mortgage.

Find out what you need to do if you want to take out a mortgage.

Sort by order/Sort by subject

Preparation

Find a mortgage advisor or take out a mortgage yourself

Getting a mortgage can be complicated. You can do it yourself or ask a mortgage advisor for help.

A mortgage advisor

knows the rules and possibilities;

provides personal advice and assesses which mortgage is most suitable for you;

consults with mortgage providers on your behalf;

requests the mortgage quote for you;

maintains contact with other parties, such as the insurer or National Mortgage Guarantee.

Find an independent advisor

You can contact an advisor who works for a mortgage lender, or an independent advisor who works with multiple mortgage lenders.

Also compare different advisors. Read theservice document (link opens in a new tab) on their website. This document states, for example, who the advisor works for and what the costs are. Read theTips if you are looking for a mortgage advisor (link opens in a new tab) on Wijzer in geldzaken.nl.

Arrange your own mortgage

A mortgage you arrange yourself is called Execution Only. Arranging a mortgage yourself is possible if your situation isn't complicated. You also need to have financial knowledge. To test this, you'll need to take a knowledge and experience test with your mortgage lender. This can be done online.

List loans and debts

Are you looking to take out a mortgage and do you have debts in the form of one or more current loans? For example, a revolving credit line, a personal loan, or student loans that you repay in installments? This will affect the maximum amount of your mortgage.

Most loans are registered with the Credit Registration Office (BKR). Mortgage lenders can view this information.

Not all loans registered with BKR

Not all loans are registered with the BKR (Credit Registration Office). Report all your loans to your mortgage lender. This way, you won't encounter any unexpected problems when you finalize your mortgage.

Report student debt

Your student debt is not registered with the BKR (Credit Registration Office). You must report your student debt to the mortgage provider yourself. The mortgage provider usually requests aproof of your original student debt (link opens in a new tab) .

If you don't disclose your student loan debt, it won't be included in your monthly payments. These could then be too high for you. You'll also lose your right to the National Mortgage Guarantee (NHG) if it later turns out you have student loan debt.

Calculate maximum mortgage

The amount of a mortgage depends on factors such as your (joint) income and debts. You can find out more on the Wijzer in geldzaken website.Calculate your maximum mortgage (link opens in a new tab) . To do this, enter your income and monthly expenses. This can also be done on the websites of most banks.

Mortgage amount and house value

You can take out a mortgage up to 100% of the value of the house.

Are you making your home more energy-efficient? Then your mortgage can often be slightly higher than the value of the property. Ask a mortgage advisor about the maximum mortgage amount.

Salary when purchasing a house

Have you found a house? On the Wijzer in geldzaken websiteCalculate how much you need to earn (link opens in a new tab) to buy this house. Your savings are also taken into account.

Discussing mortgage options (mortgage advice meeting)

During a mortgage consultation, you will discuss with the mortgage advisor which mortgage and which mortgage provider suits you best.

Contents of mortgage interview

To choose the right mortgage, you will discuss the following with the advisor:

- How much money you have and how much you can borrow.
- Your fixed costs and debts.
- Mortgage type.
- The interest on the mortgage.
- Insurance against the consequences of unemployment, being unable to work, death.
- Tax matters.
- Your plans for the future.

You can check whether you have discussed everything with the mortgage advice meeting checklist from the AFM (Financial Markets Authority).

Costs

The first meeting is an introduction. This meeting is usually free. You pay the mortgage advisor for subsequent meetings. Compare the fees of different mortgage advisors beforehand.

Thinking about National Mortgage Guarantee (NHG)

TheThe National Mortgage Guarantee (NHG) (link opens in a new tab) is a mortgage guarantee. It provides a safety net if, due to unforeseen circumstances, you can no longer pay your mortgage, or if this leaves you with a residual debt after selling your home. You take out the NHG through the mortgage lender where you take out your mortgage.

NHG only up to average house price

The NHG applies to owner-occupied homes with a purchase price up to the average house price. In 2025, the NHG threshold will be €450,000.The NHG limit is higher if you take energy-saving measures (link opens in a new tab) .

Payment arrears

Are you no longer able to pay your mortgage? Then NHG will work with you to make it affordable again. For example, with the housing costs facility. The housing costs facility is aTemporary reduction in housing costs (link opens in a new tab) during periods when you have less money, such as unemployment, disability, the end of your relationship, or the death of your partner.

Forgive residual debt

Do you have to sell your home and are you left with residual debt?NHG can forgive this residual debt (link opens in a new tab) if:

- you and your partner separate (and the mortgage is owned jointly by you and your partner);
- you become incapacitated for work or unemployed;
- your partner has died (and you had a mortgage together).

There are conditions for remission.

NHG premium

For NHG, you pay a one-time premium of 0.6% on the total loan. This premium is deductible from your income tax.

Compare mortgages

Before taking out a mortgage, it's a good idea to compare different mortgages. You can do this on various websites. You can compare repayment methods, interest rates, and monthly payments, among other things.

Also check the mortgage terms and conditions. For example, the maximum amount you can repay without penalty. Terms and conditions may vary by mortgage provider.

Choose mortgage type

You are taking out a mortgage for the first time. You are then only entitled to mortgage interest deduction ifannuity mortgage (link opens in a new tab) or aLinear mortgage (link opens in a new tab) . You repay both loans within a maximum of 30 years.

Annuity mortgage: a fixed amount every month

With an annuity mortgage, you pay a fixed amount each month. This consists partly of interest and partly of principal repayments. Initially, you pay a lot of interest and make small principal repayments. Later, you pay little interest and make large principal repayments. You can deduct the interest portion from your income tax return, but not the principal repayment.

Linear mortgage: pay less every month

With a linear mortgage, you pay a fixed amount each month towards principal. The interest decreases each month, meaning you pay less each month. A linear mortgage is therefore more expensive at the beginning than at the end.

Conditions for mortgage interest deduction

You may apply for a mortgageOnly deduct interest from your income tax return (link opens in a new tab) if you:

- pay off the mortgage within 30 years;
- immediately begins repayment.

Have your home appraised

If you want to buy a home, you must have its value assessed (appraised). The bank needs the appraisal value to determine the maximum mortgage.

Certified appraiser

Always have your home appraised by a certified appraiser. It takes about a week to receive an appraisal report. The report will include the value of your home and an explanation. Read the appraisal report carefully. If you don't understand anything, you can ask the appraiser for clarification.

Valuation report is not a building report

A valuation report is not a building inspection report. For that, you need to have a building inspection performed.

Home appraisal costs

The amount you have to pay varies by appraiser. You can deduct this amount when filing your income tax return. You can read more about deductible costs later in this overview.

Determine the value of your home by comparing houses

When you apply for a mortgage, you can sometimes determine the value of your home through a comparison. This involves comparing the property with similar properties. This is called a "model value." This method allows you to obtain a mortgage for up to 90% of your home's value. Whether this method allows you to determine the value varies, among other things, by mortgage lender and by property.

A model-based appraisal costs money. Your mortgage advisor can tell you more about the property's valuation.

Deciding who will own the house

You both become half owners of the house. You also share the mortgage debt.

If you do not want to share the house (and the mortgage), you must have this recorded inPrenuptial agreements (link opens in a new tab) . For this, you must go to a notary.

To request

Collecting documents for mortgage

You must provide certain information to obtain a mortgage, such as information about your income and the new home. Your mortgage advisor or mortgage lender will tell you which documents you need. This can vary depending on your situation. You or the mortgage advisor will forward the documents to the mortgage lender.

Information about your income

The mortgage lender may ask for:

- pay slips;
- annual statements;
- an employer's statement;
- copies of bank and savings accounts;
- an overview of your debts.

Data from entrepreneurs

Are you an entrepreneur? Then this concerns:

your annual figures for the last 3 years;

income tax assessments and returns;

the registration with the Chamber of Commerce.

Information about the house

You provide the purchase contract and the appraisal report, among other things. Sometimes a building inspection report is also required.

Other documents that you submit for the mortgage

This includes a copy of your and your partner's passports. Sometimes you also need to take out certain insurance policies, such as life insurance.

Request a mortgage offer

You or your mortgage advisor requests a mortgage offer from a mortgage lender. The mortgage offer is a proposal that includes the following:

the mortgage amount;

the mortgage type;

the term of the mortgage;

the interest rate.

Validity of mortgage offer

You usually have two weeks to accept or reject the offer. If you accept the offer, you sign it and return it to the mortgage lender.

Validity of signed mortgage offer

A signed mortgage offer is usually valid for three months. During this period, you must sign the mortgage deed at the notary's office to transfer ownership of the property. For new construction, a longer period than three months may apply. Ask your mortgage advisor or mortgage lender about the offer's validity.

Extension of mortgage offer

The transfer of ownership can sometimes take longer than three months. However, the mortgage deed can usually be signed after the expiry date. The mortgage lender may charge a fee for this. This is the commitment fee.

To block

Signing the mortgage deed and deed of transfer

You sign the mortgage deed at a notary's office. You choose the notary yourself. The mortgage deed contains the agreements you've made with the bank regarding your mortgage. The bank must also sign the deed. This is done by a notary's employee on the bank's behalf.

Notary costs

The cost of the mortgage deed varies by notary. Several websites allow you to compare notary fees. You can deduct the notary fees for the mortgage deed from your income tax. Other notary fees are not deductible.

Transfer of home

The notary draws up the deed of transfer at the same time as the mortgage deed. This is also called the deed of transfer, deed of transport, or transfer deed. Once you, the notary, and the seller have signed the deed of transfer, you own the property.

On the day you sign the mortgage deed and the deed of transfer, you usually also receive the keys to the house.

Registration with the Land Registry

Once all parties have signed the mortgage deed, the notary will register it with the Land Registry. The mortgage is then official. The notary will send you a copy of the registered mortgage deed.

Taking out building insurance

Before the property is transferred to you

Do you own a home with a mortgage? Then your mortgage lender will ask you to take out buildings insurance (home insurance). The insurance must take effect on the day you become the owner of the property. This happens at the notary's office when you sign the deed of transfer. You can read more about this in this overview under 'Signing the mortgage deed and deed of transfer'.

With home insurance, you're covered against damage to your home, for example, in the event of fire, burglary, or storm damage. The terms and conditions of your insurance policy specify what is covered.

Taking out life insurance

With life insurance, your surviving spouse can continue paying the mortgage if the other dies. Check what income your surviving spouse will have if one of you dies. This could include survivor's pension, salary, and savings.

Not mandatory

ATerm life insurance (link opens in a new tab) is usually not required when buying a home. However, some mortgage lenders do require it.

Ask your mortgage advisor about the options.

Good to know

Deducting mortgage interest and costs from income tax

You can deduct the interest you pay on your mortgage from your income when filing your income tax return. This reduces your income and reduces your income tax bill.

Condition for interest deduction

You can only deduct mortgage interest if the home is your primary residence. This means you live primarily in the home and in the neighborhood. You cannot deduct mortgage interest on a vacation home.

Annual deduction

You can deduct mortgage interest for up to 30 years in your income tax return.conditions for deducting mortgage interest (link opens in a new tab) .

Costs you can deduct when purchasing a home

You can deduct the following costs from your income tax:

- advisory and brokerage costs for your mortgage advisor;
- notary costs for the mortgage deed;
- appraisal costs to be able to take out the mortgage.

You can find out which other costs you can deduct (link opens in a new tab) from the Tax Authorities.

Download as PDF

Your answers

This is my first purchase Change

I am buying the house together with a partner Change

We are married in community of property Change

This concerns existing construction Change

This concerns a residential house Change

It is not a monument Change

Refill

To the top

Learn more about buying a house

Want to know what else to consider when buying a house? Things like costs, insurance, permits, or taxes? Then complete the Home Buying Questionnaire . You'll receive a personalized overview.

Responsible

- Ministry of Housing and Spatial Planning